Lieutenant Bikram Singh on the West Ridge. Expecting the Kumaonis to build up sufficient strength through the night, Rawlley now ordered Behl to bring 4 Sikh into play. Hoping to dislodge the Chinese by attacking them from the rear, he wanted to synchronize the Kumaonis attack with a diversion created by 4 Sikh. Accordingly, in compliance with Brigade HQ's order, a patrol under Naib Subedar Gurnam Singh set off while it was still dark with the intention of disrupting the line of communication between Green Pimple and the Chinese firm base at Ashi Hill. The party soon located the telephone line and cut it, after which they laid an ambush and settled down to await daybreak.

Soon enough a small Chinese detachment appeared to repair the telephone line, but they were accompanied by a large protection party. Completely outnumbered, the Sikhs could only hope that they would not be discovered, but the Chinese had no difficulty in locating and surrounding the Sikhs. In the initial engagement itself, two Sikhs were killed and another eight, including Gurnam Singh, grievously wounded. Meanwhile, there was no activity from 6 Kumaon who should have been streaming down on Yellow Pimple. Badly weakened owing to his injury, the JCO realized the only hope his surviving men had was for him to break through the Chinese ring. Picking up a LMG from a dead gunner, Gurnam Singh led the charge while firing from the hip. The wild charge by a few desperate men with the war cry of 'Sat Sri Akal' scattered the Chinese who broke, but not before a Chinese soldier fired a burst at point-blank range into Gurnam's chest, killing him instantly.

From the Trijunction, Madiah could only watch helplessly, as his two companies had not reached the assembly area. By the time Bravo and Charlie minus one platoon had joined up with Alpha Company at the Trijunction, the Sikhs had withdrawn to Patrol Base, managing to extricate their dead and wounded.

Back in Walong, Kaul and Mohinder Pathania had arrived to oversee the operations. As Kaul was to record later, 'I saw the casualties coming back on stretchers. Men had been hit by small arms fire and were in great pain. Before they could be taken back to a hospital, first aid was rendered to them at the Regimental Aid Post. They had been carried for four hours over uneven rocky terrain.' Not only had 11 Brigade failed to synchronize the action between 6 Kumaon and 4 Sikh, there were no helicopters standing by to evacuate the casualties. If the wounded survived the journey back to the